

Staffing



Definition of Staffing:

- Staffing is the process of ascertaining that adequate numbers and an appropriate mix of personnel are available to meet daily unit needs and organizational goals.
- It is the process of determining and assigning the right personnel with the right qualifications to the job in a right time to accomplish the purposes of the organization.



Goals of staffing:

- Appropriate numbers and mix of nursing staff
- Delivery of effective and efficient nursing care
- Increase productivity
- Avoid role confusion, communication problems and time waste
- Maintain stability in team work
- Provide each nursing unit with an appropriate number of each category of worker to perform the nursing tasks required to give care and comfort to patients in the unit.

Factors affecting staffing:

1. Patient factors:

- Patient type (age , sex, diagnosis)
- Length of stay
- Complexity of care

2. Staff factors :

- Personnel policies (vacation , overtime, part time, work)
- Educational and experiential levels of staff

3. Environmental factors :

- Number of patients' beds
- Availability of supplies and equipment

Methods of calculating staffing:

1. **Patient classification system:**

- It is system developed to objectively determine workload requirements and staffing needs

2. **Diagnostic related groups:**

- Based on the medical diagnosis of the patients

3. **Acuity and complexity of care:**

- Estimate how many hours of nursing care will be needed during a particular shift.

4. **Staffing formulas:**

- Must consider hours which coverage is required, vacations, holidays, absenteeism, and staff development time.

Manpower planning:

Manpower planning may be defined as a strategy for the acquisition, utilization, improvement and preservation of the human resources of an organization. This involves ensuring that organization has enough of the right kind of people at the right time and also adjusting the requirements to the available supply.

The main objectives of manpower planning:

1. Ensuring maximum utilization of the personnel
2. Assessing future requirements of the organization
3. Determining the recruitment sources.
4. Determining training requirements for management's development and organizational development.

Nursing Staffing Guidelines:

- **Provide an all-professional nurse staff in critical care units, operating rooms, labor and emergency room.**
- **Provide sufficient staff to permit a 1:1 nurse- patient ratio for each shift in every critical care unit**
- **Staff the general medical, surgical, obstetrics and gynecology, pediatrics and Psychiatric units to achieve a 2:1 professional-practical nurse ratio.**
- **Provide sufficient nursing staff in general, medical, surgical, obstetrics and gynecology, pediatric and psychiatric units to permit a 1:5 nurse patient ratio on a day and afternoon shifts and 1:10 nurse patient ratio on night shift.**
- **Involve the heads of the nursing staffs and all nursing personnel in designing the department's overall staffing program.**
- **Post time schedules for all personnel at least eight weeks in advance.**
- **Reward employees for long term service by granting individuals special time requests on the basis of seniority.**